

Interview Thesis Brief

Managing Director, CX AI Delivery | Candidate vision by Russell Dudek

EXECUTIVE THESIS

TELUS Digital should scale CX AI by redesigning the human-AI workshare, proving the economics in managed operations and harvesting reusable delivery advantage - not by installing more tools.

Nominal role

Lead CX AI strategy, offerings, delivery, teams, client transformation and P&L across contact-center technologies and global operations.

Actual mandate

Turn TELUS Digital's operator scale, AI talent, platform ecosystem, IP and account base into a profitable practice that grows revenue, improves margin and produces repeatable client outcomes.

Company moment

Public signals show a shift from AI deployment to optimization, forward-deployed adoption, broader voice/agentive partnerships and closer integration with TELUS.

White-space thesis

Make every target account an explicit portfolio of Human-led, Assistive, Conversational and Agentive work, governed through a shared delivery and economics review.

CURRENT PUBLIC SIGNALS

SIGNAL	IMPLICATION FOR THE ROLE
80,000+ CX operators and 900+ AI engineers/data scientists	The company can learn from real work and industrialize what proves valuable.
CCaaS, CRM and AI partners across Genesys, Five9, AWS, Google, Salesforce, Zendesk, Cresta and ElevenLabs	The leader must govern composition, partner roles and differentiation - not champion one platform.
2026 enterprise survey: deployed versus optimized gap	Adoption, knowledge, QA, coaching and operating ownership are part of delivery.
TELUS as "Day 0 client" and Humanity-in-the-Loop	Internal operating evidence and responsible work design can become a market advantage.

WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

Commercial

Offers and account transformations create qualified growth with a credible path to attractive delivery economics.

Operational

Service quality, adoption, exception control and production ownership remain visible as the workshare changes.

Strategic

Delivery learning becomes reusable offer, partner, estimation, talent and governance leverage.

Cultural

Teams treat AI as work redesign with humans in the loop, not a detached technology program.

The CX AI Workshare Map

A candidate-created operating model for account, delivery and P&L decisions.

THREE DECISION LENSES

1. Interaction workshare

Segment by complexity, risk, value, failure mode and customer intent. Assign Human-led, Assistive, Conversational or Agentic work intentionally.

2. Delivery composition

Connect platform, CRM, data, workflow, knowledge, governance, adoption and production ownership into one accountable path.

3. Practice economics

Review client outcome, service quality, adoption, delivery cost, margin, reuse and risk in the same portfolio decision.

4. Human authority boundary

Specify where AI prepares, recommends, converses, transacts or acts, and where human judgment remains mandatory.

OPERATING SEQUENCE

MOVE	DECISION	FAILURE PREVENTED
Read the interaction portfolio	Where is the work, value, risk and failure demand?	Technology-first scope.
Set the authority boundary	What may AI do, and what remains human?	Hidden autonomy and weak escalation.
Compose the delivery path	Which platform, partner, IP and operating change fit?	Tool sprawl and custom integration debt.
Prove service and economics	What evidence earns expansion?	Go-live celebrated without realized value.
Harvest reusable advantage	What becomes an offer, pattern or partner play?	Learning trapped inside one account.

CORE OPERATING TENSIONS

- Transform labor economics while protecting service continuity.
- Standardize offers while respecting client stacks and operating realities.
- Expand autonomy while preserving explicit human authority.
- Sell transformation while owning delivery and adoption reality.
- Partner broadly while differentiating through operator scale, forward-deployed learning and responsible work design.

DECISION RIGHTS TOPOLOGY

ACTOR	DECISION RIGHT
Client executive / outcome owner	Business result, risk appetite, funding and acceptance of value.
Account and CX operations	Service continuity, workforce transition, frontline ownership and exception management.
CX AI practice	Workshare, architecture composition, delivery method, evidence standard and reuse decision.
Platform / product / partners	Capability boundaries, roadmap, technical assurance and support model.
Finance / security / legal	Economics, control conditions, privacy, compliance and material-risk escalation.

Proof Map and Hard Objection

VERIFIED EVIDENCE SELECTED FOR THIS MANDATE

EVIDENCE	TRANSFERABLE MECHANISM
Vape-Jet - Director of Operations	AI-first operating transformation across production, quality, support, customer success, ERP, CRM, engineering issue flow and telemetry.
DudeWorth - Founder / AI and Automation Advisor	AI readiness, value/feasibility, data, governance, agentic workflows, human judgment, evaluation, adoption and time-to-value.
Amazon - Operations Management / Site Leader	24/7 customer-backward launch, labor planning, throughput visibility, escalation, standard work and operating cadence at scale.
Compunetics - Director of Operations and Engineering Management	High-reliability engineering, quality systems, cross-functional technical delivery, root cause and performance controls.
Cardinal Building Products - Regional Director	Remote operation buildout and distributed customer, CRM, commercial, fulfillment and logistics modernization.

STRONGEST REASONABLE OBJECTION

"Russell has not been a Partner in a top-tier CX consultancy or run a global contact-center AI P&L."

Answer: Correct. Do not hide the adjacency. Test the operating judgment. The evidence supports AI-enabled operations, scaled service execution, high-reliability technical delivery, governance, telemetry, adoption mechanisms and cross-functional accountability. The remaining gaps are CX-platform depth, global practice economics and formal consulting-partner tenure.

Discovery posture: Pair early with platform and finance leaders; learn the current P&L and delivery portfolio; use bounded account work to prove judgment; never claim specialist depth that belongs to the team.

BALANCED SCORECARD

DIMENSION	REPRESENTATIVE MEASURES
Client outcome	Resolution, growth, satisfaction or agreed journey result.
Operating behavior	Use, override, exception, coaching and escalation signals.
Quality and trust	Consistency, accuracy, safety, compliance and customer effort.
Economics	Cost-to-serve, revenue effect, delivery cost and margin trajectory.
Practice learning	Cycle time, reuse, adaptation burden and capability depth.

CANDIDATE RISK CONTROLS

RISK	CONTROL
Insufficient platform depth	Use specialist decision rights, structured technical immersion and explicit architecture review.
Over-generalizing adjacent experience	Keep claims bounded; use account casework and operating evidence rather than title equivalence.
Moving too quickly to a new framework	Read existing practice mechanisms first; retain what works and target only material decision friction.
Underestimating global change burden	Build regional operators and client stakeholders into the workshare and adoption design.

Entry Logic and Executive Questions

120-DAY ENTRY LOGIC

Days 0-30 - Read

Map P&L, pipeline, offers, delivery portfolio, partner motions, wins, misses, stalled pilots, margin leakage and decision bottlenecks.

Days 31-60 - Choose

Segment accounts, select lighthouse transformations and stop/hold candidates, define workshare, authority, evidence and commercial thesis.

Days 61-90 - Prove

Launch two bounded transformations, run a weekly outcome/adoption/economics review and capture reusable patterns during delivery.

Days 91-120 - Industrialize

Convert evidence into offer, estimation, governance, partner and talent playbooks; establish practice scorecard and portfolio cadence.

EXECUTIVE QUESTIONS

1. Where does the current CX AI P&L make money, and where does delivery or adoption quietly destroy margin?
2. Which managed accounts are structurally ready to shift from labor-based service to AI-enabled outcome models?
3. What has TELUS Digital learned as its own "Day 0 client" that is genuinely differentiated and repeatable?
4. Which decisions are unclear across Business Development, Digital Solutions, account leadership and operations?
5. Where do partnerships accelerate the offer, and where must TELUS Digital own the operating IP?
6. What twelve-month result would prove this practice changed TELUS Digital's growth and margin trajectory?

90-SECOND OPENING

TELUS Digital already has the ingredients of a differentiated CX AI practice. The opportunity is to make them compound. I would start by treating each target account as an interaction portfolio: define the human-AI workshare, authority boundary, delivery composition, evidence standard and economic thesis. Then I would use two lighthouse transformations to prove value and harvest reusable offer, partner and operating leverage.

CASE-RESPONSE STRUCTURE

1. OUTCOME	2. WORKSHARE	3. AUTHORITY	4. DELIVERY	5. ECONOMICS	6. DECISION
What must improve?	Which interactions change?	What stays human?	What stack and operating change?	What value and burden?	Invest, sequence, partner or stop?

WHAT I WOULD NOT DO

- Lead with a platform demo before reading the work and outcome.
- Promise labor reduction without service, adoption and change evidence.
- Claim specialist platform expertise that properly belongs to the team.
- Scale autonomy without clear human authority, exception control and production ownership.
- Protect weak pilots from a stop decision because they are politically visible.

PUBLIC SOURCE SET

TELUS Digital homepage; Customer Care AI and Technology; Enterprise CX AI 2026 survey; June 2026 forward-deployed CX AI article; Fuel iX; leadership; Humanity-in-the-Loop; newsroom and partnership announcements. Full links are listed on the candidate vision site.